CAMPUS NOTES



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The Art of Medicine

Stepping upon the lush expanse of AIIMS Delhi feels transformative, and I consider myself privileged to live and learn within India's most prestigious medical campus. During the week, I find myself immersed in the weekly Journal Club, guest lectures and interactive sessions where faculty and students engage freely in critical discussions. My academic duties include leading case-based discussions, problem-based learning sessions and practicals for MBBS students. These are designed to embed basic biochemical ideas in patient-centred settings, allowing future physicians to relate textbook learning with real-life clinical scenarios.

Perhaps the most intriguing portion is thesis work. Our substantial MD projects are driven by complex approaches and continuous trial and error. AIIMS supports this deeply: labs and equipment are accessible 24×7, enabling flexible work schedules.

AIIMS can be considered a microcosm of India. Residents bring with them vibrant languages, cuisines, traditions and perspectives. Festivals like Diwali, Onam, Bihu, Baisakhi, Ganesh Chaturthi and Lohri are celebrated together, and language disparities serve as natural bridges for friendships.

Of course, life here is intense. AIIMS receives a massive intake of patients, offering unparalleled clinical exposure. Residents use a variety of stress-relieving practices. Some go to the gym or swimming pool, while many, myself included, take late-night walks. For me, a week at AIIMS is an amalgam of intense academics, research opportunities, teaching and moments of community. Here, ambition finds direction and medical education is elevated to an art. ■

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TOP 5

MEDICAL UNIVERSITIES WITH BEST FACULTY STUDENT RATIO

RANK	UNIVERSITY	RATIO
1	INSTITUTE OF LIVER & BILIARY SCIENCES, NEW DELHI	2.73
2	NITTE (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), MANGALURU	2.12
3	JSS ACADEMY OF HIGHER EDUCATION & RESEARCH, MYSURU	1.79
4	NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF MENTAL HEALTH AND NEUROSCIENCES (NIMHANS), BENGALURU	1.77
5	D.Y. PATIL EDUCATION SOCIETY (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), KOLHAPUR	1.26

Note: MS/ MD student count was considered to calculate the ratio
Total faculty = permanent faculty + visiting faculty + contractual/ ad hoc faculty

UNIQUE ELEMENT
AIIMS Delhi sees over 3.5 million outpatient visits annually; over 10,000 patients visit the OPDs daily

with global institutes like the Harvard Medical School and the World Health Organization, enabling exchange programmes and joint research initiatives. The research results speak volumes. Last year, a team of PG researchers—Trapti Shrivastava, Harshal Chaudhari and Vrijendra Singh—developed a machine learning model for early autism detection.

Recently, AIIMS, in collaboration with IIT Delhi, has established a state-of-the-art Centre of Excellence for AI in healthcare, proving that it is constantly upgrading, innovating and spearheading excellence in health research.

Career prospects after PG at AIIMS Delhi are exceptional. Graduates are sought after for senior residencies, teaching posts and fellowships abroad, and leadership roles in government and private healthcare. Being a PG student at AIIMS Delhi is more than pursuing a degree, it is a transformative experience that equips doctors with the skills and confidence to lead in healthcare. ■